Andrea (Junru) Ai

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AI Safety & Governance Research · China–West AI Ecosystems · Human–AI Interaction

AI governance researcher with experience on both sides of the US–China AI landscape: safety evaluation at a Chinese foundation-model developer, then US/EU/China AI policy research at Brookings.

EDUCATION

Northwestern University — Evanston, IL
M.S. in Technology, People, and Policy (STEM) | GPA 3.93/4.0 — *Sep 2025 – Sep 2026*

- **Relevant Coursework:** Navigating AI & Data Governance; Data, Ethics & Policy; Foundations of Tech Policy; Technology, Emotion & Social Relationships; Technology, Psychology & Education Across Cultures.
- University Delegate, IASEAI 2026 Conference (International Association for Safe & Ethical AI), Paris, France.

Wuhan University of Technology — Wuhan, China
B.S. in Finance — *Sep 2021 – Jun 2025*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The Brookings Institution — Washington, D.C.
Capstone Research Fellow (with Dr. Nicol Turner Lee) — *Dec 2025 – Jun 2026*

- Restructured and authored the talent pillar of a US/EU/China AI industrial policy comparison, drawing on Chinese- and English-language sources on immigration, workforce funding, and retention.
- Co-authored 2 policy briefs on talent-retention gaps and AI model export controls, plus a comparative blog across data, algorithms, and talent, retained by Brookings as internal research material.
- Presented findings at a spring research symposium and as an academic poster at the MTePP graduation showcase, revising the argument in response to Brookings reviewers and faculty feedback.

Culture, Brain, and Human Development Lab & Technology and Human Development Lab
Research Assistant, Northwestern University (PIs: Prof. Yang Qu & Prof. Claudia M. Haase) — *Mar 2026 – Present*

- Led full-text retrieval of 265 references for a systematic review of AI in K-12 education.
- Authored a scoping review on influencer–fan psychology and a literature review on adolescents and AI products.

AI SAFETY INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE (CHINA)

StepFun (Chinese foundation-model developer) — Beijing, China
AI Safety Intern — *Dec 2023 – Apr 2024*

- Benchmarked 4 cloud content-moderation vendors across 1M+ test samples in sensitive, high-risk scenarios; computed precision/recall and delivered the vendor-selection recommendation adopted by the team.
- Designed scenario-based safety test suites and an edge-case error-log database; diagnosed false positives on AI-generated content and benchmarked safety approaches of peer Chinese labs to refine the safety-label taxonomy.

Guangdong Genius Technology (BBK Electronics group) — Dongguan, China
Content Safety / Product Management Intern — *Jun 2024 – Nov 2024*

- Screened the top 1,000 titles on BBK children's learning tablets via rule-based checks and manual spot review; stood up a recurring QA process with safety specialists to cut child-safety risk.
- Analyzed 422 user complaints using pattern recognition to surface recurring harms and latent risks; delivered corrective reports that strengthened content-safety and incident-response workflows.

Tencent — Shenzhen, China
Product Operations Intern — *May 2025 – Aug 2025*

- Built a real-time BI dashboard across 1M+ records for a Tencent Cloud product, saving 15+ hours/week.

SELECTED WRITING

- *Policy memos on export controls for frontier AI model weights*, Northwestern coursework, 2026.
- *Why adults turn to AI for intimate conversations: safety-by-design*, course paper, 2026.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Research: comparative policy analysis, Chinese/English source research, policy memos, AI safety evaluation.
Technical: Python, SQL, Tableau, Power BI, Excel (Advanced), Qualtrics, Zotero, prompt engineering.
Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent, IELTS 7.0).